important. There are nineteen Russian women, but only four can live." He sneered. "You see—fifteen women must die to avenge my brother's death." He stood. A vein pulsed on his forehead. "You choose." He lifted the report in his hand and hurled it at her. The metal ring holding the papers struck her chest and then fell to the floor.

She started, knocking her elbow on the back of the chair. She tried to stand but he'd moved first, reaching her side of the desk, blocking her way. Her pulse pounded as he placed his hands on either side of the armrests and bent close.

"Go on, choose which four will live," he said quietly.

Rose's body froze. She wanted to run—return to Léa and André. But he stood over her. A tear ran down her cheek.

"What about the pregnant one?" He smiled. "Will you order her killed?"

"None of them," she said, her voice trembling. "I don't want any of them killed."

"I didn't want Felix killed, but they murdered him, and now they must pay," he said, wiping away the tear on her face with his finger. She winced at his touch. "Rose, Rose, are you afraid of me?"

"No."

"Good. I don't want you to fear me. All I want is for you to look at the names and choose."

She glanced at the pages splayed on the floor—the report Léa had painstakingly typed with the nineteen Russian names all in a row. Her mind flashed to Léa's warning on the train about getting too involved with Reinhardt. Now she understood the consequences. Trapped by his demand to choose who would live or die, Rose's realization jolted her: she'd underestimated his madness. Steeling herself, she slid her chair back to stand, but he blocked her. "I can't choose."

"Oh, I think you can. If you don't, I'll kill all the women—is that what you want?"

She shook her head. "No."

"Then listen to me carefully." He stared hard at her.

Rose didn't flinch or look away. He was so close that for the first time she saw the narrow, ragged lines of the scar on his left cheek, the black rims framing his blue eyes, the juddering Adam's apple in his throat. And it was as if she was seeing him for the first time.